

Safari 3 beta For Windows

Apple recently released the Safari 3 beta version for Windows XP and Vista users. (Safari is the default browser on Macs.) Within 48 hours of its release, over a million downloads were recorded. However, three security researchers independently found eight vulnerabilities in the first 24 hours.



YouTube Remixer

YouTube has launched an online editing tool at their site, the YouTube Remixer, powered by Adobe. The Remixer can be used for joining video clips, photos, music, graphics, and other special effects. This means YouTube members can now create more professional-looking videos.



Enter

Shweta Kawatra

Actress

Kawatra started her career as a model in Delhi for big names like Hemant Trivedi and Lubna Adams. She has been an actress since 1995.

Kawatra's break in her acting career came from her lead roles in soap operas—in *Kahani Ghar Ghar Ki*, followed by her role as Eesha in *Kkusum*.

Technology to you is

The future! It allows us to have a better life and a better standard of living.

What gadgets do you use?

I have a mobile phone and use a computer for designing my own Web site. My husband has promised to buy me a laptop if I do a good job with the site.

What would your dream gadget be, and why?

A gadget that would teleport me from one place to another. I am tired of this Mumbai traffic.

What do you do online?

Due to my busy schedule, I hardly spend any time on the Net. But when I do, I reply to my fan mail. I have made a resolution to become more tech-savvy. Otherwise my children will soon treat me like an outcast!

Any instance where technology has really helped you?

On 26 July, 2005, Mumbai was flooded. I was stuck in traffic and didn't know what was happening. Thanks to my mobile, I was informed of the magnitude of the flooding and took shelter in a hotel.

DEVELOPERS' DELIGHT

From Web To Desktop

We've been talking about conventional desktop applications moving to the Web as Rich Internet Applications (RIAs). These are Web applications that typically work within a Web browser, and have features and functionalities similar to those of Desktop applications.

More technically, RIAs are like layers of code added between the user's end and the Web server to perform certain tasks by asynchronous communication within them. For instance, when you visit an RIA-based Web site that has an online word processor (like Google Notebook), code gets transferred to your system. This code acts as a browser extension and communicates with the server. The code renders the user interface of the application to make it more responsive. As you keep writing in Google Notebook, supplementary code keeps getting downloaded.

Different technologies—ActiveX controls, Adobe's Flash, JavaScript, Java applets, AJAX, Windows Presentation Foundation, and other user interface markup languages—are used in the development of RIAs. The limitation of RIAs is that they are only functional online. And now, to overcome that limitation, a number of development tools have been—and are being—released.

Google recently released Google Gears, an open source browser extension that enables Web applications to be available offline. Google Gears offers three chief features—it can act as a local server, as a database,



and can make applications work in the background.. If your Internet connection fails and you need to check your Gmail, Google Gears makes it possible: data held on a Web server can be stored as a database on a Desktop computer. When a connection is established, the data is synchronised with the corresponding Web-based applications.

Adobe, too, has launched a similar cross-platform tool named Adobe AIR (Adobe Integrated Runtime, earlier code-named Apollo) for developers to build and deploy advanced RIAs. Using the Adobe AIR framework, RIAs can be built using

Adobe Flash, Flex, HTML, JavaScript, and AJAX to make them work online as well as offline. Google is working with Adobe on AIR to make further development of APIs for running Web applications offline possible.

"The Gears API will also be available in Apollo, which enables Web applications to run on the desktop, providing developers with consistent offline and local database solutions," said Kevin Lynch, senior vice president and chief software architect of Adobe.

Microsoft's Silverlight offers the ability to build APIs for online Web applications and also make those APIs work offline on desktops: like Flash.

In May, Sun announced its JavaFX technology in response to Silverlight; it is more appealing to Flash and AJAX developers because it's simpler. JavaFX products will cater to the RIA market for mobile devices, Desktops, TV set-top boxes, and more. As you can see, Google Gears along with Adobe's AIR, Silverlight, and JavaFX will compete in this space.

There's also the Dojo offline toolkit, out recently, which will allow AJAX developers to enable AJAX services to run easily while offline. In sum, what we're witnessing is the online / offline gap being plugged. Of course, that line can never be totally erased, but life is getting better.